

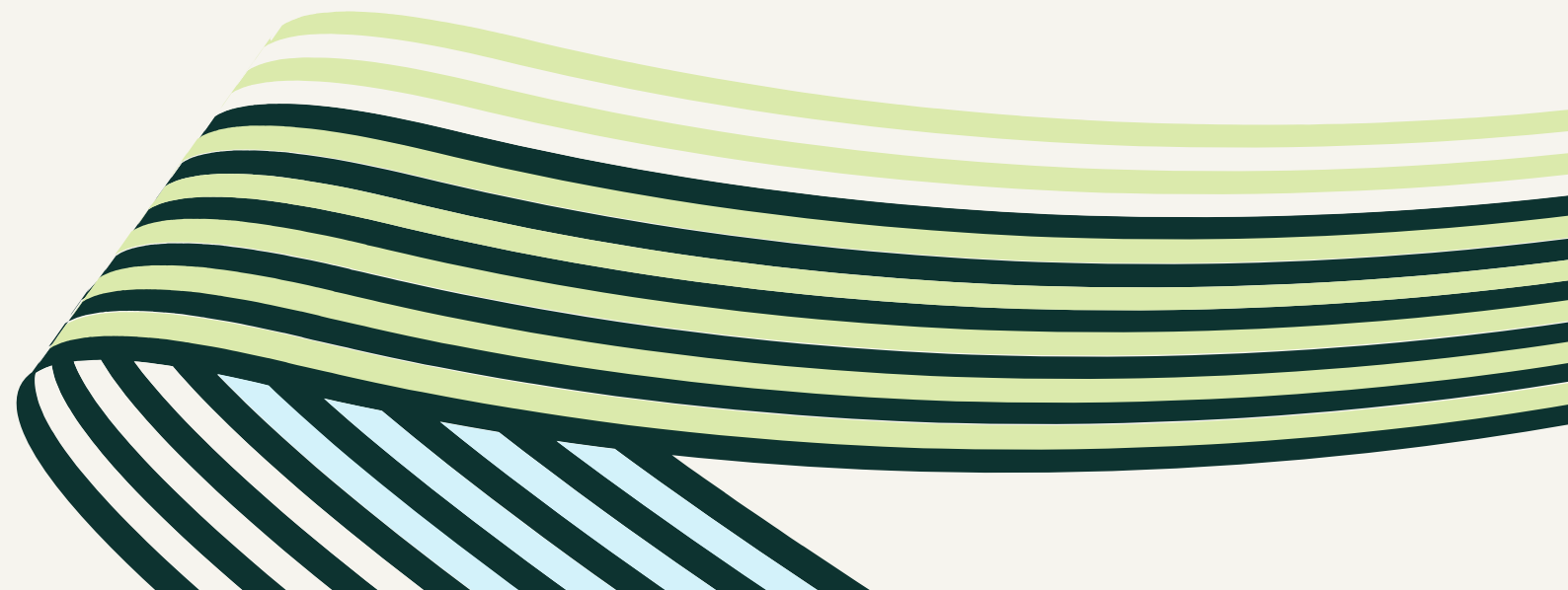


Tarlac Agricultural University
Department of Research and Development
University Research Ethics Office



RESEARCH ETHICS REVIEW AND EVALUATION PROCESS

***Your Guide to Ethical Evaluation
Process***



WHAT IT IS RESEARCH ETHICS?

Research ethics refers to the principles and guidelines that ensure research is conducted responsibly.

KEY TERMS DEFINED

- **Risk:** Refers to the potential harm (physical, psychological, social, or economic) that participants, animals, or the environment might face as a result of the research.
- **Minimal Risk:** Means that the harm or discomfort anticipated in the research is not greater than those encountered in daily life or during routine medical, psychological, or social procedures.
- **Invasive Procedure:** A research method that penetrates or disrupts the normal functioning of a participant's body or of an animal or plant. For example, collecting blood samples is considered invasive.
- **Sensitive Data:** Refers to personal information about participants that could lead to discrimination, stigma, or harm if disclosed. This may include health data, financial records, and personal identifiers.
- **Vulnerable Populations:** Participants who are at greater risk of exploitation or harm, such as children, the elderly, pregnant women, or individuals with mental disabilities.
- **Hazardous Materials:** Substances that could pose a danger to human, animal, or environmental health, such as chemicals, pathogens, genetically modified organisms (GMOs), or biohazardous agents.
- **Informed Consent:** A process in which participants are given detailed information about the research, including its purpose, risks, benefits, and their rights, allowing them to voluntarily decide whether or not to participate. Consent forms must be clear, understandable, and appropriately documented, ensuring that the participant agrees freely without coercion.
- **Certificate of Instrument Validation:** serves as official documentation that a data gathering instrument has been reviewed by experts or validators.
- **University Research Ethics Committee:** is a multidisciplinary body that reviews, evaluates, and monitors research proposals to ensure they uphold ethical principles such as respect for participants, integrity, and social responsibility.

RESEARCHER'S RESPONSIBILITIES

- ✓ Obtain informed consent to participants
- ✓ Keep information confidential
- ✓ Minimize risks to participants
- ✓ Report updates to REO
- ✓ Acknowledge REO approval in methodology



UNDERSTANDING RESEARCH ETHICS REVIEW CATEGORIES

Research ethics review falls under three categories: Exempt, Expedited, and Full Review. These categories determine the level of review your research will undergo.

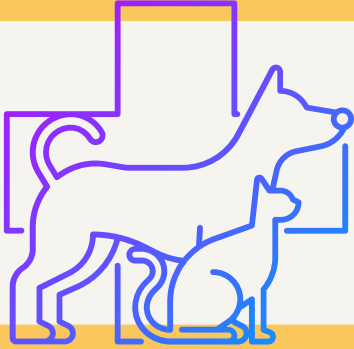
1. **Exempt Review** – Research with no to minimal risk. Typically involves observational or survey research where participants, animals, or plants are not directly intervened upon in harmful ways.
2. **Expedited Review** – Research that involves minimal risk to participants or involves non-invasive methods, basic data collection, or routine practices with minor interventions.
3. **Full Review** – Research that involves high risk, such as vulnerable populations, sensitive data, invasive procedures, or research that can have significant ethical concerns or environmental impacts.



TYPES OF ETHICAL REVIEW

Human Subject and Instructional Materials Use -

Studies involving human participants. Mostly involves the surveys or interviews, health related research, psychological assessment, and educational practices.



Institutional Animal Care and Use - Research that involves animals in testing, observation, or experimentation to study behavior, health, nutrition, or other biological factors. This ensures ethical treatment of animals and prioritizes welfare

Microorganisms and Biotechnology Products

Use - Research involving microbial research, bioremediation, and pharmaceutical development. Often requiring strict biosafety protocols.



Information Technology Use - Research focusing on development of digital tools or applications, data security, AI ethics, digital platforms, and human-computer interaction.

Engineering Use - Research involving machinery development, infrastructure, automation, and innovative technology that addresses safety, efficiency, and sustainability concerns in various industries.

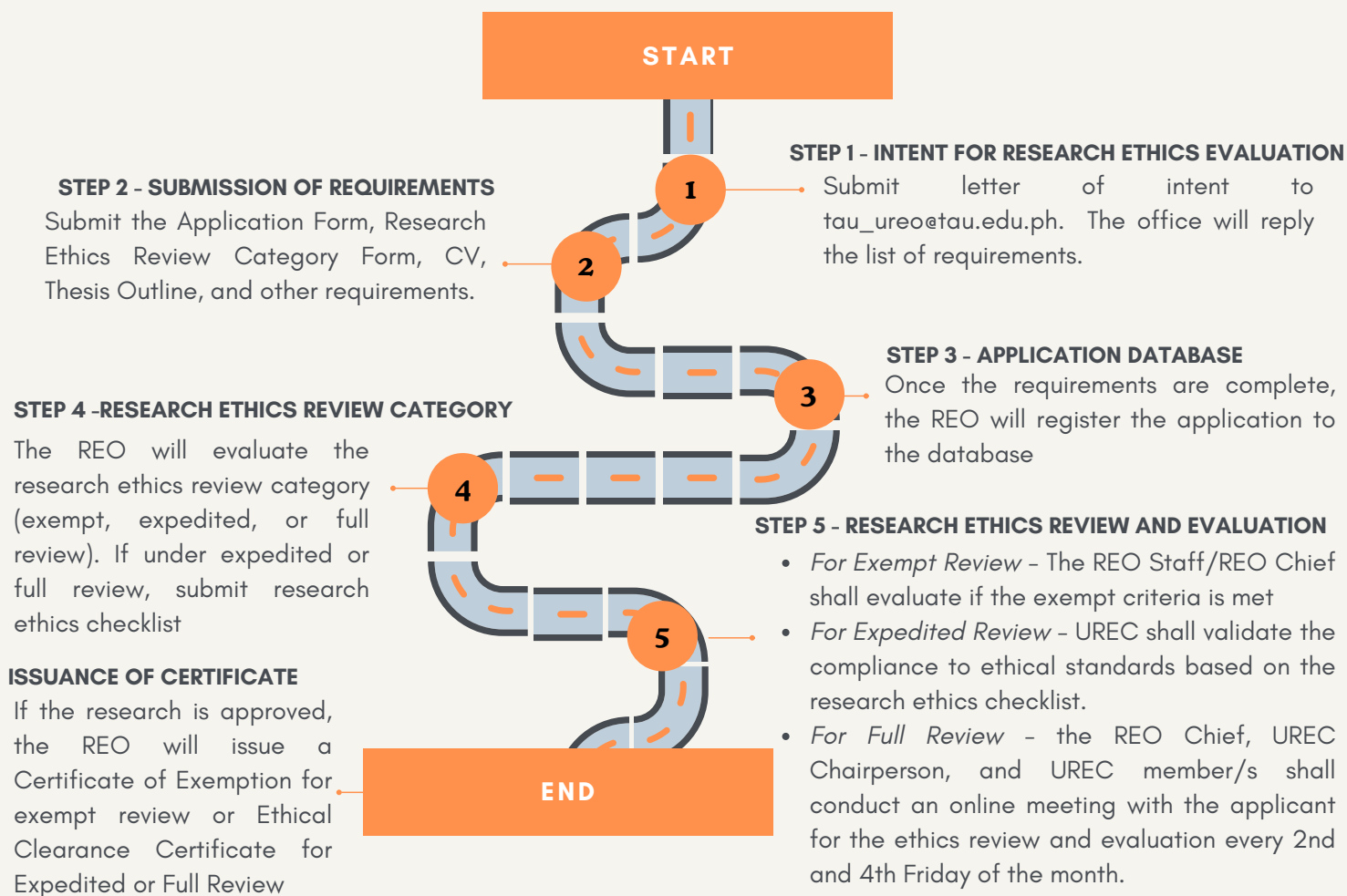


Plant/Crop Care Use - Research involving the cultivation, modification, conservation, or utilization of plant species for agricultural, medicinal, or environmental purposes

Food Technology Use - assess research protocols that involve food processing, development of new food products, sensory evaluations, food safety assessments, and use of indigenous or local food knowledge.



RESEARCH ETHICS REVIEW AND EVALUATION PROCESS



OTHER REQUIREMENTS

These are list of requirements that may be needed to your application. Kindly follow the guidelines below:

- Data Gathering Instruments - this may include survey forms, interview guide, or checklist.
- Informed Consent Form - follow the elements as listed below:

Elements	YES	NO	N/A
1. The letterhead of TAU is used			
2. Identity of the researcher and contact information			
3. Research topic/question, nature of participation, duration, and research procedures			
4. Risks and benefits of participation			
5. State how feedback is provided to the participants			
6. Confidentiality and/or anonymity			
7. Point of withdrawal and refusal to answer questions			
8. Section for Consent/ assent to participate in the study			
9. Parent/Guardian Assent Form			
10. Point of withdrawal in the Parent/Guardian Assent Form			

- Certificate of instrument validation - follow the format below and attach a signed copy:

CERTIFICATE OF INSTRUMENT VALIDATION

This is to certify that the data gathering instrument for the research entitled: " _____ " by the researchers _____, has been reviewed and validated by the undersigned.

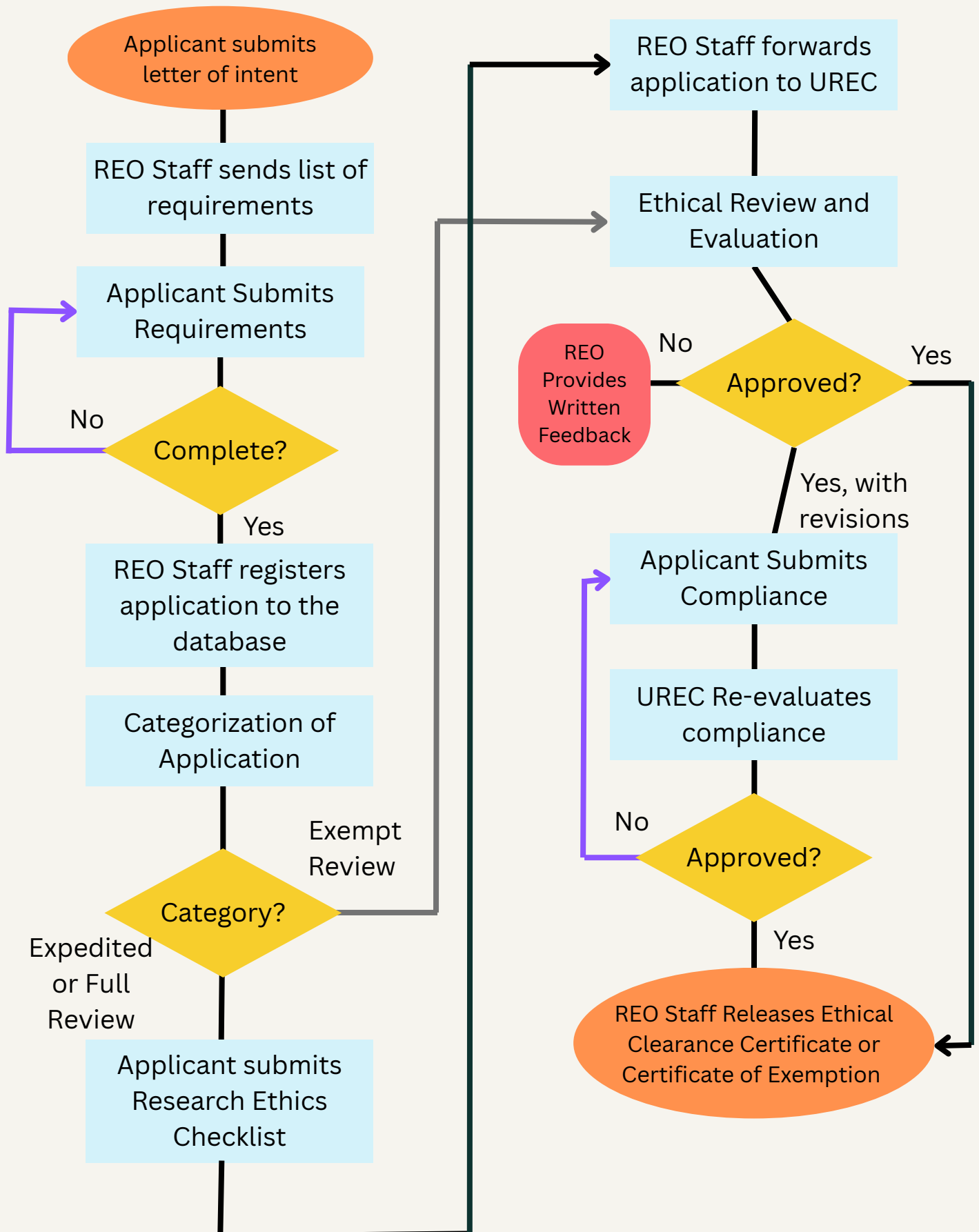
The validation process included an evaluation of the structure of the instrument, question formulation, and suitability for the target respondents. Based on the assessment, the survey instrument is deemed valid and appropriate for data collection.

This certification is issued for documentation and research compliance purposes.

CERTIFIED BY:

NAME AND SIGNATURE
Designation
College/Institution

RESEARCH ETHICS REVIEW AND EVALUATION PROCESS



TIMELINE OF RESEARCH ETHICS REVIEW AND EVALUATION

Step	Process	Responsible Person	Cycle Time
1	Submission of Letter of Intent	Applicant	1 working day
2	Sending List of Requirements	REO Staff	1 working day
3	Submission of Requirements	Applicant	2 working days
4	Registration of Application	REO Staff	2 working days
5a	Research Ethics Review and Evaluation	REO Staff and UREC	Exempt Review - 5 working days Expedited Review - 10 working days Full Review - 15 working days
5b	If with revisions, applicant complies with the comments	Applicant	5 working days
5c	UREC Conducts Re-evaluation	UREC	5 working days
6	If approved, certificate is issued	REO Staff	3 working days